

NIKITA RAI

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Professional Summary

Risk, Controls and Compliance Audit manager with 12+ years of global experience, MBA from The University of Edinburgh and CA from ICAI. Expertise in designing, implementing and testing SOX-compliant control frameworks meeting PCAOB standards across 2nd and 3rd lines of defence. Delivered \$7M+ in monetary recoveries through systematic controls testing across \$2M-\$372M projects in Technology, SaaS, and Financial Services. Built SOX-compliant control frameworks reducing gaps by 60% and led 13-member finance team. Proven ability to execute end-to-end audits, assess control effectiveness, drive remediations, and deliver impactful findings to board-level committees across global operations. Cross-industry expertise spanning global technology MNCs, SaaS, and agritech with varied business models from subscription-based to cash-intensive operations.

Key Skills

Risk Controls & Audit: Enterprise Risk Management (ERM) | Risk-Based Scoping & Assessment | GRC Systems (AuditBoard) | Control Gap Analysis | Project Management | Internal Controls Design & Testing | Cross-Functional Team Leadership | Fraud Detection & Prevention | Stakeholder Management | Audit Lifecycle | COSO Principles | Audit & Risk Committee Reporting

ISO Standards & Compliance: ISO Audit Support (ISO 27001, 9001, 31000, 19011, 37301, 28000) | Familiarity with Environmental, ISO 55000 | SOX Compliance | GDPR | Regulatory Compliance | Sanctions & Export Controls

Finance: Budgeting | Forecasting | Financial Reporting | MIS Reporting | IFRS | Cost Analysis | Variance Analysis | Internal Financial Controls (IFC) | GAAP | Cash Flow management | Authorization matrix

Technical Tools: Microsoft Office | Data Analysis & Visualization (AI, Power BI, Tableau) | AI-Powered GRC Tools | GRC Platforms | ERP Systems (SAP) |

Professional Experience

Senior Internal Auditor: Risk & Customer Audit Specialist (EMEA)|Oct 2022-Present

Intel Corporation (UK) Ltd

- Executed **SOX-aligned risk and compliance audit** and onsite controls testing across EMEA and Asia covering rebates ranging from **\$13 mil to \$220 mil**.
- Drove **monetary recoveries and ranging from \$80k to \$6.85 mil** and partner compliance improvements through systematic control deficiency identification and corrective action program.
- Performed risk-based scoping by analysing large data sets through internal **dashboards, AI powered tools**, and external sources to assess control risks for **projects valuing between \$2 mil and \$372 mil**.
- **Partnered with Marketing, IT, and Supply Chain teams to assess risk areas and conduct root cause analysis, identify systemic issues**, and develop enterprise-wide control improvements.
- **Extensively travelled across EMEA & Asia (35%)** to conduct on-site process walkthroughs, interviews, warehouse & integration facility inspection and internal control effectiveness assessments while evaluating regulatory compliance, **fraud prevention, sanctions, export controls, and GDPR adherence**
- **Owned full audit cycle** encompassing risk-based analysis, designing test of controls, contract analysis, traveling onsite, budgeting, evidence gathering, workpaper management, results evaluation, and audit closure
- Drove customer compliance through **strategic negotiation** and relationship building, **influencing key decisions** that strengthen operational controls and authorization processes.
- Led strategic advisory engagements and consulting projects including process improvement, **fraud investigation escalations, cost benefit analysis, operation risk assessment for government tenders** and high-value Intel components.
- **Designed SOX-compliant control testing frameworks** and audit procedures tailored to complex customer profiles, including control matrices and test scripts **aligned with COSO principles**
- **Designed and conducted training/learning sessions** for the auditors across the globe through actual audit cases to identify control gaps, assess risk tolerance, and design tests of controls

- Prepared high-impact, **executive level audit reports** for senior management and **board-level compliance committees** with control gaps analysis, risks insights and risk mitigation recommendations.

Finance Manager | Sep 2020 - Sep 2021

Clover Ventures Pvt Ltd

Agritech startup in Bangalore connecting farmers directly to consumers and B2B clients (hotels, caterers, supermarkets) through online platform and supply chain operations. High-growth, cash-intensive business requiring strong financial controls across multi-state operations

- **Led 13-member finance team** managing ₹100M+ multi-channel revenue
- Managed **cash flow, forecasting and liquidity** across 3 banks; optimized cash positioning for seasonal working capital
- **Owned and co-ordinated external audits** - Investment due diligence, internal and external auditors (BDO, GT)
- **Detected and addressed ₹0.6M fraud** through control framework
- Designed SOX-compliant internal controls framework from ground up (segregation of duties, authorization matrices, financial reporting); **reduced control gaps by 60%**
- **Reduced working capital cycle by 40%** and vendor costs by 35% through payment term negotiations with 70+ suppliers
- Delivered Series B reporting, **burn rate analysis, 13-week cash flow projections**, and investor MIS

Finance Manager | Mar 2017 - Aug 2020

Quintype Technologies Pvt Ltd (Quintype Inc)

New York-headquartered media-tech SaaS company providing digital publishing platform to 300+ publishers globally with subscription-based revenue model. Managed financial operations including investor relations, Series B due diligence coordination, and recurring revenue accounting for high-growth startup.

- **Managed financial planning, budgeting, and reporting** for ₹80M+ turnover; reduced costs by 25% and working capital cycle by 15% via contract restructuring
- Owned consolidated reporting **under US GAAP and IFRS-aligned statutory reporting**, including revenue recognition for subscription-based SaaS model, deferred revenue accounting, and investor reporting.
- Oversaw **statutory/internal audits as primary external auditor liaison; coordinated audit queries ensuring timely completion (KPMG)**
- **Managed vendor payment cycles** and credit term negotiations; recovered ₹3.8M through escalation resolution
- Established internal control framework over financial reporting covering revenue recognition, expense authorization, and month-end close; **reduced material weaknesses by 30%**

Education

MBA, The University of Edinburgh | 2021-2022

Specializations: Strategy, Operational Improvement, Finance

Chartered Accountant (CA), The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI) | 2008-2012

Integrated Professional Competency Course | Common Proficiency Test